

Patient 101: Lesson 6

Real Steps.
Less Stress.
A Healthier You!

Post-ER / Urgent Care Follow-Up

Closing the loop the ER opened.

Empowering Health Together

You are
not a bother!

Follow-up care helps
prevent repeat visits,
catches problems early,
and keeps you on the
path to better health!



The ER Discharge Checklist

Before you walk out of the ER
or Urgent Care, ask the nurse to
confirm you have all four items.
They belong to you!



DIAGNOSIS

What did they find?



NEW MEDICATIONS

Complete list with exact
dose & how often,
noting what changed.



WARNING SIGNS

Explicit instructions
on what to watch for.



FOLLOW-UP INSTRUCTIONS

Specific guidelines on
who to see next.

Ask questions if something
is not clear. You deserve
to understand your care!

FOLLOW UP

BETTER CARE

BRIGHTER
TOMORROWS

Part 1: The Three Post-ER "Locks"



1

Schedule It Fast



Call your primary care
doctor within a few days.
Don't wait for them to
call you — they may not
even know you were seen!

I was seen on

Date: _____

and scheduled my
follow-up for

Date: _____

Early follow-up helps
keep you safe and
on track.

2

Confirm the Record Transfer



Do not assume records
transfer automatically.

Ask directly:

"Did the records from
my ER visit on [Date]
get sent to your office?"

If they didn't, request
them from the ER or
bring your physical
discharge papers
with you.

Your records matter
for your ongoing care.

3

Bring the Papers & Questions



That discharge paperwork
is gold.

Bring it, read from it, and
walk in with your three
questions ready.

Same information.
One team.
Better care.

Be prepared.
Be informed.
Be your own best advocate.

Part 2: Walk In With These Three Questions

These questions help you get the clarity you need.

1

What was this?

(Understand the diagnosis in plain terms.)

2

What do I do now?

(Confirm the ongoing treatment and
management plan.)

3

What would send me back to the ER?

(The most important, life-saving question
you can ask!)



Scheduling "No-Freeze" Phone Script

"Hi, I was seen in the
emergency room on [Date]
and was told to follow up
with my primary care doctor.
I'd like to schedule that
follow-up visit this week,
please."

It's okay to make the call!
You're taking care of you!

Closing that loop is on you — and it is worth it.

Empowering Health Together

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PATIENTS • FAMILIES • STRONGER TOMORROWS

Today's
Follow-Up
Builds a
Healthier
Tomorrow.